

- 24** A gene codes for the production of a protein, p53, that binds to damaged DNA during interphase and prevents its replication. A carcinogen in cigarette smoke mutates this gene.

Which statement explains why this mutation may cause cancer?

- A** Cells with no p53 are allowed to undergo mitosis.
- B** Cells with no p53 allow their damaged DNA to replicate.
- C** The carcinogen in cigarette smoke increases the rate of cell division.
- D** The p53 causes uncontrolled cell division.